The Government of India Act, 1935 extended the principle of communal representation by providing separate electorates for depressed classes (scheduled castes), women and labourers (workers). A separate electorate meant that not only were the seats reserved for a specific group, but voting for the reserved constituency was allowed for only members of that specific community. Hence statement 2 is correct.
Hence option (b) is the correct answer.

12. With reference to 8th August, 1942 in Indian history, which one of the following statements in correct?
(a) The Quit India Resolution was adopted by the AICC.
(b) The Viceroy's Executive Council was expanded to include more Indians.
(c) The Congress ministries resigned in seven provinces.
(d) Cripps proposed an Indian Union with full Dominion Status once the Second World War was over.

Ans. (a): On 8th August, 1942 the quit India Movement resolution was adopted by the All-India Congress Committee.
Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

13. Who among the following is associated with 'Songs from Prison', a translation of ancient Indian religious lyrics in English?
(a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi
(d) Sarojini Naidu

Ans. (c): 'Songs from Prison' is a book of translation from Sanskrit hymns and lyrics, from the Upanishads and other scriptures. Mahatma Gandhi made these translations during his incarceration in Yerwada Prison in 1930. Translations of works by Manu, Tulsidas, Kabir, Nanak, Mirabai, Ramdas, Tukaram and many other poets. Gandhi prepared these translations mainly for his English friends and especially for Mirabehn.
Hence, option (c) is the correct Answer.

14. Who among the following was associated as Secretary with Hindu Female School which later came to be known as Bethune Female School?
(a) Annie Besant
(b) Debendranath Tagore
(c) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(d) Sarojini Naidu

Ans. (c): In 1856, the Government took charge of the Hindu Female School, later renamed as Bethune School. The Managing Committee of the school was then formed and Pandit Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar, the celebrated social reformer responsible for the eradication of the custom of Sati and a relentless supporter of women's emancipation was made the Secretary.
Hence, Option (c) is the correct answer.

15. In the context of Colonial India, Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar Sehgal and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon are remembered as
(a) leaders of Swadeshi and Boycott Movement
(b) members of the Interim Government in 1946
(c) members of the Drafting Committee in the Constituent Assembly
(d) officers of the Indian National Army

Ans. (d): In the context of colonial India, Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar Sehgal and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon were the officers of the Indian National Army.
Hence, Option (d) is the correct answer.

Art and Culture

16. With reference to Chausath Yogini Temple situated near Morena, consider the following statements :
1. It is a circular temple built during the reign of Kachchhapaghata Dynasty.
2. It is the only circular temple built in India.
3. It was meant to promote the Vaishnava cult in the region.
4. Its design has given rise to a popular belief that it was the inspiration behind the Indian Parliament building.

Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c): The Chausath Yogini temple is in Morena district in M.P. the temple was built by the Kachchhapaghata king Devapala (1055-1075).
1. It is not the only circular temple built in India.
2. It was to promote the Shiva temple.
3. The uniqueness of this yogini temple is its circular shape that is popularly believed to have inspired the design of the Indian parliament.
Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

17. Which one of the following statements is correct?
(a) Ajanta Caves lie in the gorge of Waghora river.
(b) Sanchi Stupa lies in the gorge of Chambal river.
(c) Pandu-lena Cave Shrines lie in the gorge of Narmada river.
(d) Amaravati Stupa lies in the gorge of Godavari river.

Ans. (a): The most prominent examples of the rock-cut architecture of this period are found at Ajanta and Bagh (Huntington, 1985: 239–74). The spectacular Buddhist site of Ajanta consists of several caves nestled in a curving section of the Sahyadri hills, overlooking the Waghora river. There are 28 caves at Ajanta. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.
Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

18. With reference to India, the terms 'Halbi, Ho and Kui' pertain to
(a) dance forms of Northwest India
(b) musical instruments
(c) pre-historic cave paintings
(d) tribal languages

Ans. (d): Some of the popular languages spoken by the tribes of India are as follows: Bhatri, Halbi, Ho, Kui etc. Halabi is spoken by over 5.25 Lakh people in the states of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh. It belongs to the group of Indo Aryan Tribal languages. Important Dravidian Tribal languages are Kolami, Kui, Konda, Koya, Gondi, Oraon/Kurukh, Parji.
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY

Physical Structure & Human Geography/ Drainage System

19. With reference to the Indus river system, of the following four rivers, three of them pour into one of them which joins the Indus direct. Among the following, which one is such river that joins the Indus direct?
(a) Chenab (b) Jhelum
(c) Ravi (d) Sutlej

Ans. (a): The Indus originates in the northern slopes of the Kailash range in Tibet near Lake Manasarovar. It follows a northwesterly course through Tibet. It enters Indian territory in Jammu and Kashmir. The main tributaries of the Indus in India are Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas and Sutlej. Jhelum and Ravi join Chenab, Beas joins Sutlej, and then Sutlej and Chenab join to form Panjnad, 10 miles north of Uch Sharif in Muzaffar Garh district. The combined stream runs southwest for approximately 44 miles and joins the Indus River at Mithankot.
Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

20. With reference to India, Didwana, Kuchaman, Sargol and Khatu are the names of
(a) glaciers (b) mangrove areas
(c) Ramsar sites (d) saline lakes

Ans. (d): Didwana, Kuchaman, Sargal and Khatu are the name of saline lakes which is situated in Rajasthan.
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

21. Consider the following rivers :
1. Brahmani 2. Nagavali
3. Subarnarekha 4. Vamsadhara

Which of the above rise from the Eastern Ghats?
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 3

Ans. (b) :
Brahmani and Subarnarekha originate from central Indian Plateau regions.
Vamsadhara River is an east-flowing river which originates in Kalahandi district of Odisha ie. Eastern Ghats. The River Nagavali also known as Langulya is one of the main rivers of Southern Odisha and Northern Andhra Pradesh States in India, between Rushikulya and Godavari basins.
Statement- 1 and 3 are incorrect, while 2 and 4 are correct.
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

Monsoon/ forest/soil/ Irrigation project/ and Agricultural

22. The black cotton soil of India has been formed due to the weathering of
(a) brown forest soil
(b) fissure volcanic rock
(c) granite and schist
(d) shale and limestone

Ans. (b) : The Black soil are so called because of their black colouration and derived from the Basalt rock under semi-arid conditions. It is also known as 'Regur' (from the Telugu word Reguda) or black cotton soil as it is best suited for cotton cultivation. In India black soil are largely found over Deccan trap region of the states of Maharshtra, Madhya Pradesh, parts of Andhra Pradesh, Northern part of Karnataka, Gujarat, parts of Tamil Nadu and Rajasthan.
Several theories have been put forward regarding the origin of this group of soils but most pedologists believe that these soils have been formed due to the solidification of lava spread over large areas during volcanic activity in the Deccan Plateau, in the Triassic Period.
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

Tropical Zone & World Forest Area.

23. Consider the following statements :
1. In the tropical zone, the western sections of the oceans are warmer than the eastern sections owing to the influence of trade winds.
2. In the temperate zone, westerlies make the eastern sections

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Statement 1 is correct. Warmer water is transported westward in the ocean by the Northeast trade winds in the Northern hemisphere of the tropical zone (as the figure given below shows). So, in tropical zones, the western section of ocean is warmer than eastern sections due to trade winds.
Statement 2 is correct. Similarly, the Westerlies play an important role in carrying the warm, equatorial waters and winds to the western coasts of continents (that is eastern section of the Oceans in temperate zone). Thus, in temperate zones, westerlies make the eastern section of the ocean warmer than the western sections.
Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

24. "Leaf litter decomposes faster than in any other biome and as a result the soil surface is often almost bare. Apart from trees, the vegetation is largely composed of plant forms that reach up into the canopy vicariously, by climbing the trees or growing as epiphytes, rooted on the upper branches of trees." This is the most likely description of